

County Executive (11)
Office For The Disabled (11_0600)

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

- ✓ Expanded ParaTransit service by utilizing car for hire services by providing ridership with service alternatives and reducing costs to the overall program. Added car service focusing on the mid/southern portion of the County while maintaining service in the Peekskill service area.
- ✓ Enhanced the ParaTransit ridership experience by booking trips through a mobile app service. Riders now have the choice of booking trips through by speaking with a live agent, booking a trip online and using a mobile app. These three options provide riders with more flexibility during the regular business hours and also when our offices are closed.
- ✓ Set up the ParaHelp email address (ParaHelp@westchestercountyny.gov) for riders to email the appropriate individuals when they are in need of help or have a simple question. This email address is channeled to multiple individuals who are able to reply quickly with the needed information to assist our riders each day.
- ✓ Expanded the Accessible Parking Program through the use of the “Kids on the Block” Puppet Program. Use of this program, along with a disability awareness program, provides educational opportunities to all County residents in relation to the disabled community. Incorporate individuals from Cerebral Palsy of Westchester to be presenters of the Kids on the Block Puppet Program in various presentations to local school students.
- ✓ Partnered with the Miracle League of Westchester by expanding the program to approximately 650 participants in the adult league and 250 participants in the children’s league. Continued providing additional programs offered through the Halloween Extravaganza, Golf Outing, End of the Season Awards and Barbeques, and Pasta Night for the adult and children's programs.
- ✓ Continued growth of the Disability Awareness Program Westchester County School Districts, local college undergraduate and graduate programs focusing on disabilities and bringing awareness to the community throughout Westchester County.
- ✓ Partnered with the Metro North Railroad Accessibility Committee providing oversight related to the disabled community of Westchester

County in providing full accessibility to the local trains and train stations. Coordinated introduction to the Westchester Council for the Blind in partnering with this committee in accessing new mobility tools offered at the White Plains Train Station in 2024.

- ✓ Coordinated with Westchester County Office of Equal Employment Opportunity in providing training on the American Disabilities Act to county department supervisory staff as it relates to request for a reasonable accommodation.
- ✓ Coordinated with the Westchester Council for People with Disabilities new initiatives focusing on mobility tools offered at the Westchester County Airport, Out and About Online Newsletter, The Bedford Inclusion Initiative and the class action lawsuit against LYFT brought by Westchester Disabled on the Move and H.L. by Attorney Jeremiah Frie - Pearson.
- ✓ Contracted with Sign Language Interpreter agencies in providing interpreters to county departments providing a greater list of available sign language interpreters when needed.
- ✓ Provided ADA and Fair Housing Reasonable Accommodation training for the Mental Health Empowerment Project for a statewide offering virtually held in Albany.

SERVICE INDICATORS:

	2023 Actual	2024 Estimated	2025 Planned
Individuals Served:			
Public Education and Outreach	14,492	18,000	17,500
Programs and Special Events	5,325	5,500	5,750
Direct Services	15,805	14,500	15,000
Total Population Served	35,622	38,000	38,250

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Objects of Expenditure		Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
Personal Service:							
Annual-Regular:	GROUP						
Director - Office for the Disabled	XVIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Admin Aide - CE	X	1	1	1	1	1	1
Community Work Asst.	IX	2	2	2	2	3	3
Staff Asst (Advoc & Comm Svcs-SS)	VIII	1	1	1	1		
Jr. Staff Asst. - CE	VI	1	1	1	1	1	1
		6	6	6	6	6	6

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Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
100 Annual Regular Salaries	1010 Net-Annual Regular	547,187	515,902	515,902	515,902	537,996	537,996
		547,187	515,902	515,902	515,902	537,996	537,996
300 Material & Supplies	3600 Printing & Office Suppl	2,376	2,600	2,600	2,600	2,600	2,600
	3700 Postage Costs	4,702	5,500	5,500	5,500	6,500	6,500
		7,078	8,100	8,100	8,100	9,100	9,100
400 Expenses	4070 Equip Service & Rental	861	1,100	1,100	1,100	900	900
	4110 Travel and Meals	0	500	500	500	500	500
	4140 Communications	750	1,000	1,000	1,000	900	900
	4980 Program for Disabled	48,656	36,800	36,800	36,800	36,800	36,800
		50,266	39,400	39,400	39,400	39,100	39,100
599 Inter-Departmental Charge	5205 Information Support Svc	227,413	224,404	224,404	224,404	226,087	226,087
		227,413	224,404	224,404	224,404	226,087	226,087
Total Expenditures		831,944	787,806	787,806	787,806	812,283	812,283
99S Inter-Departmental Revenue	9508S Inter Dept Billings	232,624	232,624	232,624	232,624	232,624	232,624
		232,624	232,624	232,624	232,624	232,624	232,624
Net Expenditures		599,320	555,182	555,182	555,182	579,659	579,659
Net Department Total		599,320	555,182	555,182	555,182	579,659	579,659

Westchester County

County Executive (11)

Office Of Economic Development (11_0710)

Mission Statement

The mission of the Westchester County Office of Economic Development (OED) is to support and strengthen the county's economy through job creation generated by retention and expansion of existing businesses and attraction of new businesses.

In 2020 the OED developed a long-term comprehensive economic development strategy (CEDS). The primary recommendation in the CEDS report was to implement workforce and business development strategy that focused on four key sectors: Biosciences, Advanced Manufacturing, Clean Energy and Technology (health tech, fin tech and other technologies.) Since that time we have added Entrepreneurship and Quantum as areas of focus.

The sector-based approach allows OED to focus human and financial resources in a targeted way to ensure a comprehensive and coordinated process to attract and retain businesses, create and retain jobs, and to provide incentives to businesses that align with the strategy. It also allows to focus key messages to promote economic development within the County and market Westchester County to external markets.

OED acts as a central business hub for companies accessing a variety of opportunities including: financial assistance (Westchester County Industrial Development Agency – CWIDA), employee training and recruitment (Westchester-Putnam Workforce Development Board), access to state benefits (Empire State Development). OED acts on behalf of nonprofit entities as well as through the County's Local Development Corporation (LDC) which affords tax free status to bonds issued by private lenders to such entities. Ultimately, OED is the main link between businesses and Westchester County government.

	2024	2025
POSITIONS		
Operating	4	4
Grants		
	4	4
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	712,459	755,172
Equipment		
Material & Supplies	9,610	9,000
Expenses	6,270,749	1,847,785
Interdepartmental Charges	6,632	4,055
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	6,999,450	2,616,012
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental		
Departmental	490,619	489,082
State and Federal Aid	2,666,653	199,397
TOTAL REVENUES	3,157,272	688,479
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	3,842,178	1,927,533

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	<u>2024</u>	<u>2025</u>
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	89,613	97,177
Health Insurance and Benefits	141,002	146,532
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	4,072,793	2,171,242

The Appropriated 2024 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order.

County Executive (11)
Office Of Economic Development (11_0710)

PROGRAM AREA AND SERVICES:

GENERAL GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

- ✓ Provide assistance to businesses seeking to remain, expand or relocate within Westchester.
- ✓ Communicate available resources to businesses and to assist start-up, small, minority- and women-owned businesses, service-disabled veteran-owned businesses and disadvantaged business enterprises.
- ✓ Promote Westchester as a premier business location through external outreach, such as digital communications, advertising, events, public relations, seminars, etc.
- ✓ Promote Westchester as a great place to live, work and play to talent of all ages, but specifically to a younger workforce.
- ✓ Communicate and meet with businesses to offer all available resources and services.
- ✓ Work closely with Westchester-Putnam Workforce Development Board in their efforts to train and employ Westchester residents and make employers aware of these opportunities.
- ✓ Respond to individual requests from County residents and businesses for business information and assistance.
- ✓ Collaborate with business and community leaders to respond to and address concerns regarding business opportunities.
- ✓ Coordinate and act as support for the Westchester County Industrial Development Agency and the Local Development Corporation.

DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES:

NEW

- ✓ Develop and implement a comprehensive strategy that ensures Westchester County and NYS are the leaders in quantum technologies.
- ✓ Continue to implement recommendations from the Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy (CEDs).

Small Business Sector

- Continue to improve the ED website so it is easier for small businesses to find the resources they need.
- Continue to coordinate with the County Clerk to meet with owners of new businesses in Westchester County.
- Continue to enhance our ability to provide access to capital through loans and grants for small businesses.

Life Sciences Sector

- Implement the recommendations from the EDA Grant funded study of our Life Sciences sector. For example, we will apply for an implementation grant to establish a comprehensive and dynamic database of local suppliers for the medical device industry. Organize and convene supplier network events to introduce companies to local vendors. This will strengthen our life sciences supply chain resilience.

Clean Energy

- Working with our Clean Energy Accelerator, implement solutions to enable our Clean Energy solution providers to grow their businesses.

Advanced Manufacturing

- Continue to grow the pre-apprenticeship program to train entry-level workers to be prepared to work in this sector. Look for other ways to build this sector.

Technology

- Continue to grow our tech startup community through the Element 46 Accelerator program
- Engage the investment community in understanding the wealth of tech startups here in Westchester, through the Element 46 Accelerator program pitch events, to draw more investment capital into the County.

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ON-GOING

- ✓ Continue to implement a marketing plan to attract businesses and talent to Westchester. This includes paid advertising in the region, social media marketing and updates to the website.
- ✓ Communicate economic development events, programs and information to the Westchester business community through outreach through social media, email newsletters, the strategic placement of articles in business publications and distribution of press releases to the media.
- ✓ Communicate business resources to small, startup, minority- and women-owned businesses, service-disabled veteran-owned businesses and disadvantaged business enterprises through workshops and communication efforts cited above through our Catalyst for Diversity events.
- ✓ Gather and communicate economic, demographic and real estate trends in Westchester County and the Hudson Valley region.
- ✓ Promote Westchester County as a premier business location through multiple media outlets and news publications.
- ✓ Work with local, regional and state economic development offices.
- ✓ Respond to and direct small business inquiries to resources that provide access to capital.
- ✓ Represent the County Executive in any and all initiatives and before any Boards and Councils to communicate OED goals, strategies, opportunities and efforts.

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- ✓ Continued the implementation of the recommendations in Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy (CEDS) report. The primary recommendation was to implement a workforce and business development strategy that focused on four key sectors: Biosciences, Advanced Manufacturing, Clean Energy, and Technology and we have subsequently added Entrepreneurship and Quantum Technologies. We continue to add events and programming to grow these sectors.
- ✓ Established the Clean Energy working group consisting of employers and other key stakeholders in this sector. This laid the foundation for the Clean Energy Accelerator program in which we identify gaps in workforce training. Have conducted two job fairs focused on Clean Energy.
- ✓ The sector-based approach allowed OED to focus human and financial resources in a targeted way to ensure a comprehensive and coordinated process to attract and retain businesses, create and retain jobs. It also enables us to focus key marketing messages to promote economic development within the County and market Westchester County to external markets.
- ✓ Developed and implemented additional programs to foster the biosciences sector in Westchester. Held seminars/panels to showcase the breadth of organizations and resources in this sector in the County. Implemented a biosciences-focused weekly newsletter. Conducted a tour which brought key influencers in the Life Sciences from around the region to Westchester to enable them to meet with the growing life sciences companies here.
- ✓ Attended and exhibited at the BIO International conference with the goal of increasing visibility of Westchester County with companies in this sector.
- ✓ Developed and implemented a marketing plan to attract businesses and talent to Westchester. This included paid advertising in the region, social media marketing and updates to the website.

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- ✓ Developed and implemented new sections of the ED website. Added detailed information about our efforts in the area of Quantum technologies.
- ✓ In response to requests from our employers conducted career fairs for People with Diverse Abilities, Formerly Incarcerated Individuals. Conducted Catalyst for Diversity events to help our MWBEs learn how to obtain contracts with County Departments, NYPA and the MTA.

ON-GOING

- ✓ Continue to be a clearinghouse for businesses and employers to contact for information on all resources and services from the County to the public and private sector.
- ✓ Communicate economic development events, programs and information to the Westchester business community via outreach through social media, email newsletters, the strategic placement of articles in business publications and distribution of press releases to the media.
- ✓ Participate in regional promotional efforts with the Hudson Valley Regional Council, New York State Economic Development Council and Empire State Development.
- ✓ Continue to inform local Chambers of Commerce, employers of all sizes and individuals about County business assistance resources.

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Objects of Expenditure		Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
Personal Service:							
Annual-Regular:	GROUP						
Director of Economic Development		1	1	1	1	1	1
Sr. Asst. to the County Executive II	XVIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Assistant to CE I	XII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Admin Aide - CE	X				1	1	1
Asst. Secretary to County Executive	VI	1	1	1			
Total Positions		4	4	4	4	4	4